21 Oct 2026 11:19:39 ET | 13 pages

NRG (NRG.N)

Q3 Preview: Guide Refresh, Committed to First Data Center Deal by YE

CITI'S TAKE

We update our Q3 EBITDA estimate to ~$1.8B on ERCOT power price headwinds and walk through key debates into Q3 guidance and capital plan refresh, including NRG's data center strategy, timing of first data center deal by YE or earlier, and less impact on Vivint from new market entrants.

Upcoming 2027 Guidance Update — NRG plans to provide FY2027 guide and capital plan on Q3 call. Known items for 2027 imply $5,758M EBITDA, driven by $5,575M 2026 midpoint, $468M tailwinds ($175M LS power January contribution, $93M higher capacity revenue, $200M legacy NRG organic growth), $225M Texas power market headwinds, and $60M PJM headwinds.

Committed to First Data Center Deal by YE — We have been getting many concerns regarding NRG's pace of executing data center deals vs peers (Chevron, etc.). NRG indicated that the ERCOT audit caused delay, but the announcement of NRG's first data center deal does not have to be after the Nov 3 election or the Dec 10 Batch Zero/audit update. The project already received support from key stakeholders in Texas, NRG already filed a community packet to offer benefits, and the project is not exposed to 765kV or local transmission upgrades. For projects in PJM, we think the timeline may be slightly delayed given policy uncertainty around IRAS (formerly Connect & Manage) and hyperscalers' hesitancy around absorbing curtailment risk.

Not Monetizing Turbines — NRG was clear that it is not looking to monetize turbines in any way, and there are contractual provisions with GEV that deter this behavior.

Less Worried about Apple New Home Products — As Apple recently announced its Home Collection, some investors are concerned it would crowd out NRG's Vivint business. We are less worried as they don't seem to be direct competitors. Apple's offering is product only while Vivint offers an integrated solution with services.

Capital Allocation — NRG guided $1B share buybacks in 2027. NRG indicated it is less likely to increase buybacks above $1B given limited flexibility at ~4x leverage by YE26 but may sell non-core power assets to create shareholder value.

Q3 Estimate Revision — We adjusted our Q3 EBITDA from ~$1.83B to ~$1.8B to reflect lower margins from lower ERCOT power prices. Earnings release dates not announced as of this publication.

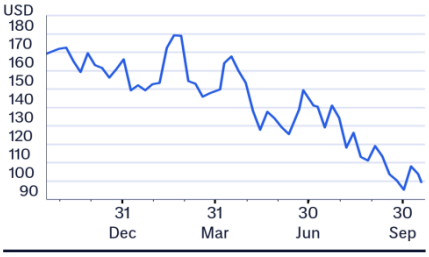
EPS (US$)	Q1	Q2	Q3	Q4	FY	FC Cons	VA Cons
2025A	2.62A	1.73A	2.75A	0.99A	8.08A	8.07A	8.07A
2026E	**1.48A**	**1.49A**	**3.84E**	**2.03E**	**8.81E**	**8.73E**	**8.69E**
Previous	1.48A	1.49A	3.95E	2.04E	8.91E	na	na
2027E	**4.17E**	**0.98E**	**4.39E**	**1.91E**	**11.45E**	**10.66E**	**10.79E**
Previous	4.17E	0.98E	4.39E	1.91E	11.45E	na	na
2028E	**4.53E**	**1.25E**	**4.82E**	**2.19E**	**12.80E**	**12.71E**	**12.79E**
Previous	4.53E	1.25E	4.82E	2.19E	12.80E	na	na

Source: Company Reports and dataCentral, Citi Research. FC Cons: First Call Consensus. VA Cons: Visible Alpha Consensus.

Click here for Visible Alpha consensus data

Buy	
Price (20 Oct 26 16:00)	US$97.84
Target price	US$180.00
Expected share price return	84.0%
Expected dividend yield	1.9%
Expected total return	85.9%
Market Cap	US$20,567M

Price Performance
(RIC: NRG.N, BB: NRG US)



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NRG.N: Fiscal year end 31-Dec

Price: US$97.84; TP: US$180.00; Market Cap: US$20,567m; Recomm: Buy

Profit & Loss (US$m)	2024	2025	2026E	2027E	2028E
Sales revenue	28,130	30,713	34,370	34,327	34,888
Cost of sales	-22,100	-24,761	-26,541	-25,424	-25,596
Gross profit	6,030	5,952	7,829	8,903	9,292
Gross Margin (%)	21.4	19.4	22.8	25.9	26.6
EBITDA (Adj)	**3,741**	**4,087**	**5,421**	**6,143**	**6,532**
EBITDA Margin (Adj) (%)	13.3	13.3	15.8	17.9	18.7
Depreciation	-1,403	-1,406	-1,893	-1,945	-2,022
Amortisation	0	0	0	0	0
EBIT (Adj)	**2,424**	**1,845**	**3,283**	**4,196**	**4,507**
EBIT Margin (Adj) (%)	8.6	6.0	9.6	12.2	12.9
Net interest	-651	-741	-1,230	-1,290	-1,352
Associates	20	11	1	2	2
Non-Op/Except/Other Adj	-345	19	37	0	0
Pre-tax profit	**1,448**	**1,134**	**2,091**	**2,908**	**3,157**
Tax	-323	-270	-397	-611	-663
Extraord./Min.Int./Pref.div.	-67	-67	-67	-67	-67
Reported net profit	**1,058**	**797**	**1,627**	**2,230**	**2,427**
Net Margin (%)	3.8	2.6	4.7	6.5	7.0
Core NPAT	1,340	1,607	1,823	2,288	2,491

Per share data	2024	2025	2026E	2027E	2028E
Reported EPS ($)	4.99	4.01	7.86	11.16	12.47
Core EPS ($)	6.32	8.08	8.81	11.45	12.80
DPS ($)	1.91	2.07	2.24	2.24	2.25
CFPS ($)	12.44	12.18	13.66	19.73	21.67
FCFPS ($)	10.22	6.41	8.78	16.18	18.02
BVPS ($)	8.87	5.29	21.94	26.84	32.90
Wtd avg ord shares (m)	206	195	207	200	195
Wtd avg diluted shares (m)	212	199	207	200	195

Growth rates	2024	2025	2026E	2027E	2028E
Sales revenue (%)	-2.4	9.2	11.9	-0.1	1.6
EBIT (Adj) (%)	158.4	-23.9	78.0	27.8	7.4
Core NPAT (%)	349.7	19.9	13.4	25.5	8.8
Core EPS (%)	383.7	27.7	9.1	30.1	11.7

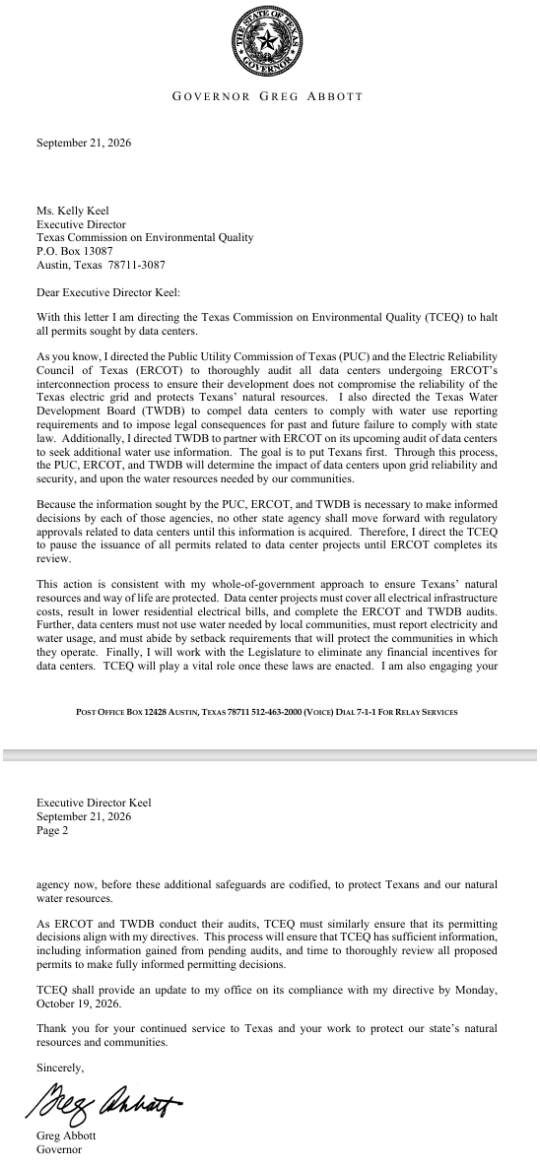
Balance Sheet (US$m)	2024	2025	2026E	2027E	2028E
Cash & cash equiv.	966	4,708	227	648	2,153
Accounts receivables	3,488	4,065	3,584	3,684	3,784
Inventory	478	461	793	793	793
Net fixed & other tangibles	5,384	7,083	17,203	16,168	15,056
Goodwill & intangibles	7,919	7,326	10,955	10,955	10,955
Financial & other assets	5,787	5,497	6,781	6,781	6,781
Total assets	**24,022**	**29,140**	**39,543**	**39,029**	**39,523**
Accounts payable	2,513	2,834	2,579	2,579	2,579
Short-term debt	996	66	1,512	1,512	1,512
Long-term debt	9,812	16,412	21,021	19,676	19,130
Provisions & other liab	8,223	8,147	9,250	9,250	9,250
Total liabilities	**21,544**	**27,459**	**34,362**	**33,017**	**32,471**
Shareholders' equity	2,478	1,681	5,181	6,013	7,051
Minority interests	0	0	0	0	0
Total equity	**2,478**	**1,681**	**5,181**	**6,013**	**7,051**
Net debt (Adj)	**9,842**	**11,770**	**22,306**	**20,540**	**18,489**
Net debt to equity (Adj) (%)	397.2	700.2	430.6	341.6	262.2

Valuation ratios	2024	2025	2026E	2027E	2028E
PE (x)	15.5	12.1	11.1	8.5	7.6
PB (x)	11.0	18.5	4.5	3.6	3.0
EV/EBITDA (x)	7.8	7.4	6.8	6.7	6.0
FCF yield (%)	10.4	6.6	9.0	16.5	18.4
Dividend yield (%)	2.0	2.1	2.3	2.3	2.3
Payout ratio (%)	30	26	25	20	18
ROE (%)	51.8	55.8	58.5	45.1	41.3

Cashflow (US$m)	2024	2025	2026E	2027E	2028E
EBITDA	3,827	3,251	5,176	6,141	6,530
Working capital	-743	-1,098	-874	-300	-300
Other	-446	270	-1,475	-1,898	-2,013
Operating cashflow	**2,638**	**2,423**	**2,827**	**3,943**	**4,217**
Capex	-472	-1,147	-1,010	-710	-710
Net acq/disposals	-38	-596	-7,101	0	0
Other	486	105	47	0	0
Investing cashflow	**-24**	**-1,638**	**-8,064**	**-710**	**-710**
Dividends paid	-405	-411	-463	-447	-438
Financing cashflow	**-1,755**	**3,546**	**680**	**-2,811**	**-2,001**
Net change in cash	**856**	**4,335**	**-4,554**	**421**	**1,505**
Free cashflow to s/holders	**2,166**	**1,276**	**1,817**	**3,232**	**3,507**

For definitions of the items in this table, please click here.

Figure 1. Texas Governor Letter Ordering Audit



GOVERNOR GREG ABBOTT

September 21, 2026

Ms. Kelly Keel
Executive Director
Texas Commission on Environmental Quality
P.O. Box 13087
Austin, Texas 78711-3087

Dear Executive Director Keel:

With this letter I am directing the Texas Commission on Environmental Quality (TCEQ) to halt all permits sought by data centers.

As you know, I directed the Public Utility Commission of Texas (PUC) and the Electric Reliability Council of Texas (ERCOT) to thoroughly audit all data centers undergoing ERCOT's interconnection process to ensure their development does not compromise the reliability of the Texas electric grid and protects Texans' natural resources. I also directed the Texas Water Development Board (TWDB) to compel data centers to comply with water use reporting requirements and to impose legal consequences for past and future failure to comply with state law. Additionally, I directed TWDB to partner with ERCOT on its upcoming audit of data centers to seek additional water use information. The goal is to put Texans first. Through this process, the PUC, ERCOT, and TWDB will determine the impact of data centers upon grid reliability and security, and upon the water resources needed by our communities.

Because the information sought by the PUC, ERCOT, and TWDB is necessary to make informed decisions by each of those agencies, no other state agency shall move forward with regulatory approvals related to data centers until this information is acquired. Therefore, I direct the TCEQ to pause the issuance of all permits related to data center projects until ERCOT completes its review.

This action is consistent with my whole-of-government approach to ensure Texans' natural resources and way of life are protected. Data center projects must cover all electrical infrastructure costs, result in lower residential electrical bills, and complete the ERCOT and TWDB audits. Further, data centers must not use water needed by local communities, must report electricity and water usage, and must abide by setback requirements that will protect the communities in which they operate. Finally, I will work with the Legislature to eliminate any financial incentives for data centers. TCEQ will play a vital role once these laws are enacted. I am also engaging your

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Executive Director Keel
September 21, 2026
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agency now, before these additional safeguards are codified, to protect Texans and our natural water resources.

As ERCOT and TWDB conduct their audits, TCEQ must similarly ensure that its permitting decisions align with my directives. This process will ensure that TCEQ has sufficient information, including information gained from pending audits, and time to thoroughly review all proposed permits to make fully informed permitting decisions.

TCEQ shall provide an update to my office on its compliance with my directive by Monday, October 19, 2026.

Thank you for your continued service to Texas and your work to protect our state's natural resources and communities.

Sincerely,

Greg Abbott
Governor

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Source: Citi Research

NRG

Company description

NRG, a Fortune 500 company, is one of the largest competitive energy retailers. It has three business branches: Generation, Retail, and Vivint Smart Home (acquired). The Generation business consists of a fleet of ~13GW capacity. The Retail business sells power, natural gas, and home and power services to 5.4 million residential customers as well as C&I and wholesale customers. Vivint offers smart home services to over 2 million subscribers. NRG is headquartered in Houston, Texas.

Investment strategy

We rate the shares of NRG Buy (1). We believe that non-core assets will be successfully divested, significant cost savings initiatives will be implemented, and the capital structure will be simplified. NRG Retail has a strong and sustainable margin profile, and it serves as a natural hedge for the generation business and can generate sustainable benefit going forward. We also believe that the current integration plan under strong management execution can create incremental platform value and organic FCF growth. We think there is further FCF upside to NRG from potential premium power contracts with hyperscalers at planned additive gas generation sites.

Valuation

We arrive at our target price of $180 through a blended average of a sum-of-the-parts valuation, an EV/EBITDA multiple, and a P/E multiple, incorporating recent acquisitions. We derive a value from our SOTP analysis: we value Generation and Retail through a DCF, and we value Vivint through its transaction price, and we subtract to account for Holdco debt. We derive a value through the EV/EBITDA multiple approach, applying a 8.0x multiple on 2027 EBITDA to reflect value accretive new build power plants, constructive view of Texas sparks, and the scarcity value of public IPPs. We also applied a 16.0x P/E multiple on 2027 adjusted EPS estimate. On top of these, we add $20 to all valuation approaches to account for NPV of potential datacenter deals and potential interconnection sales.

Risks

Wholesale Power Market Risk – NRG is exposed to power market fluctuations as it operates its merchant business. Generated power without long-term contracts (i.e., hedges) will be sold at wholesale market prices and could get lower or higher merchant power prices depending on the market conditions. As datacenter growth is forecasted to drive incremental power demand and rising power prices, there are risks to the stock story if datacenter load growth doesn't materialize.

Commodity Risk – The changes in natural gas, coal, oil, and other commodity prices, which are beyond the company's control, can significantly impact profitability of NRG. The company relies on its coal, oil, gas and other fuel suppliers to generate power; hence, these counterparties are essential for continuing operation of the company.

Operational Risk – NRG sells forward a significant amount of its generating capacity and can incur substantial penalties if it is not be able to deliver on these obligations.

Execution Risk – Execution of Vivint integration/synergies through cross-selling, organic growth through margin enhancement, and cost cutting is a key risk.

Capital allocation decisions and market dynamics for IPPs are also critical.

If the impact of the above risks turns out to be greater/less than we expect, the shares could fail to achieve/exceed our target price.

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Appendix A-1

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Ratings and Target Price History
Fundamental Research

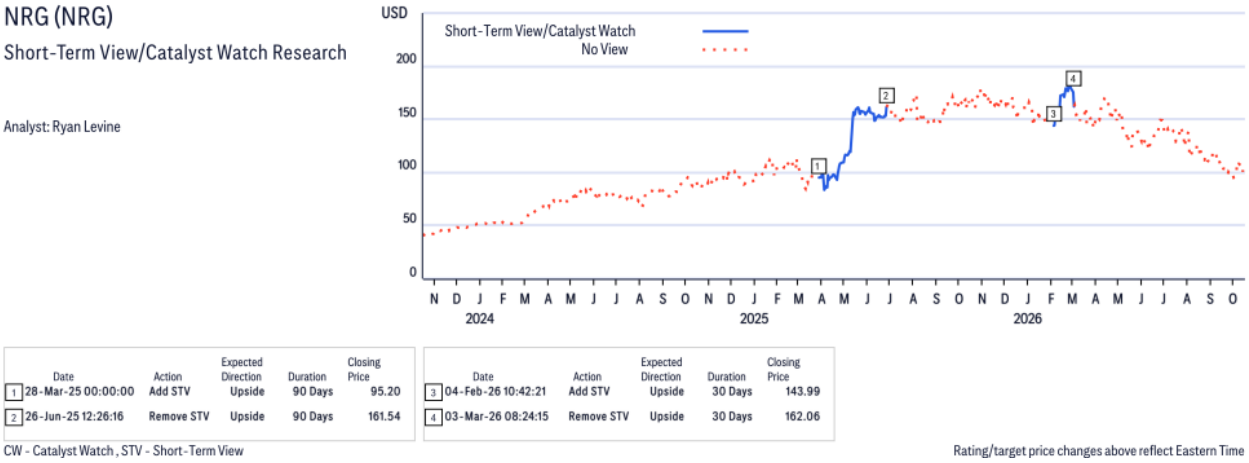
Analyst: Ryan Levine



	Date	Rating	Target Price	Closing Price
1	06-Nov-23 17:59:54	1	*52.00	45.74
2	29-Feb-24 12:08:22	1	*62.00	55.32
3	08-May-24 06:06:18	1	*84.00	75.82
4	30-Oct-24 14:15:12	1	*100.00	88.45
5	28-Mar-25 04:00:00	1	*133.00	95.20
6	16-Jul-25 18:26:59	1	*180.00	144.96

*Indicates Change

Rating/target price changes above reflect Eastern Time



	Date	Action	Expected Direction	Duration	Closing Price
1	28-Mar-25 00:00:00	Add STV	Upside	90 Days	95.20
2	26-Jun-25 12:26:16	Remove STV	Upside	90 Days	161.54
3	04-Feb-26 10:42:21	Add STV	Upside	30 Days	143.99
4	03-Mar-26 08:24:15	Remove STV	Upside	30 Days	162.06

CW - Catalyst Watch , STV - Short-Term View

Rating/target price changes above reflect Eastern Time

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	12 Month Rating			Catalyst Watch		
Data current as of 01 Oct 2026	**Buy**	**Hold**	**Sell**	**Buy**	**Hold**	**Sell**

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